

Syllabus

Mobile Application Development

Fall 2026

Professor:

Barry Burd

E-mail: bburd@drew.edu

Video chat: <https://tinyurl.com/MeetWithBarry>

Office hours:

I'll be available for video chat whenever I'm at my computer, and I'm not doing anything that requires my undivided attention. This includes many evenings, some weekday afternoons, and some weekend hours. I generally send out an email when I log onto Google Meet, so you'll get lots of these emails during the semester. If you need to schedule a specific time to meet with me, just let me know via email.

Course description:

Developing apps for mobile devices such as smartphones and tablets. Topics include the application life cycle, the model-view-controller pattern, GUI layouts, event handling, user experience issues, the adapter pattern, customizing an app for a diverse set of devices, programming with fragments, and connecting mobile apps to databases. A semester's offering focuses on either the iPhone or Android platforms, but not both. A student who takes the course when one platform is emphasized may repeat the course when the other platform is emphasized.

Moodle:

(This course doesn't use Moodle.)

Text:

There's no required textbook for this course, but if you want to read a book about Flutter, I highly recommend *Flutter For Dummies*, ISBN: 1119612586.

Learning outcomes of the course:

- Writing elegant, efficient code in the Dart programming language
- Writing apps for mobile devices.
- Making the appropriate choices in the design of the mobile app user interface.
- Writing code to use many of the Flutter features that we discuss in class, and possibly others that you research on your own.
- Using AI to write code.
- Interacting with others to create applications.
- Communicating effectively about your applications.

Course format:

This semester, I'll start by experimenting with a workshop format. (Notice the words "start by experiment." All this is subject to change as the semester goes on.) I'll lecture infrequently. For

most of the time, you'll be working in groups to create projects. At first, you'll choose your own groups and decide on your own projects. (Again, "At first" means we may change these rules if we find a better way to do things.) I'll encourage you to do vibe coding with AI as much as you see fit. But you should make every effort to **understand the code that the LLMs are creating**. (Otherwise, you'll probably end up with "AI slop.") One of my goals this semester is to figure out how to motivate everyone to understand the generated code.

Course grading:

Your final letter grade is based 85% on in-class [presentations](#) and 15% on [attendance](#).

Note: The grading scheme details for this course are much less specific than they are for a typical computer science course. If you're not comfortable with that, come talk to me.

Oral presentations:

At any time during the semester, you can volunteer to do a presentation. In most cases, the presentation will be about a project you're working on individually or with your group. For a typical project presentation, you'll

- Show us what the project can do
- Tell us how you planned, created, tested, and refined the project
- Explain any interesting aspects of the project's Dart/Flutter code
- Tell us about the project's limitations
- Explain any difficulties you had in creating the project thus far
- Say what you expect to do next with the project
- Anything else you want to say
- (Maybe some other things that I'll think of later)

For each presentation, you'll get between 1 and 10 points, and your points will accumulate throughout the semester. (I can't predict what the overall scale will be at the end of the semester. It's highly unlikely to be a 100-point scale.)

My criteria for judging your presentation are as follows:

- Did the material that you presented have sufficient depth? (Was it on the level of the material that we've been covering in class? If not, was it deeper or shallower than the course material?)
- Did you describe the material clearly?
- Did you understand the material that you were explaining or admit to any parts that you didn't understand?
- Did you speak extemporaneously (instead of reading your talk)?
- Did you acknowledge any source materials that you used, including quotations, images, diagrams, and so on? (You don't have to include a formal bibliography -- just some note for each item telling us where we can find the item. I don't care about the format of any of these notes.)
- Did you do more (in any way) than simply show us the source materials?

In judging your presentation, I'll try my best to account for peoples' shyness, stage fright, and other irrelevant criteria. At times, I may ask everyone in class for help with the judgement. My judgement **will not** suffer with any incorrect answers that you volunteer to give in class. My judgement **will not** suffer with any social incidents in class (accidentally saying out loud that I'm a "doofus," for example). My evaluation **will not** be affected by any discriminatory criteria such as (but not limited to) criteria based on age, disability, national origin, pregnancy, race/color, religion, retaliation, sex, sexual orientation, or gender identity. If you suspect that I've judged your work or anyone else's work based on invalid criteria, you have every right to bring this to my attention.

We'll have a friendly, non-threatening atmosphere for the oral presentations. We'll ask questions, but we won't do so in a challenging way. If you don't know the answer to a particular question, just say so and we'll happily move on. If you're confused about a concept that you think you should cover in your talk, let us know and we'll try to be helpful.

Attendance policy:

I'll be taking attendance automatically using Acadly. Get the Acadly app using the iPhone's App Store or Google's Play Store. Enroll on your smartphone with the following course code: WW1QPL. Enrollment costs \$3.00. (If you don't have a smartphone, please let me know.)

If you can't attend a particular class period, send me an email and let me know you won't be attending. Valid reasons for not attending include being contagious, feeling too sick to go anywhere, observing a religious holiday, having a family emergency, having an unmovable appointment, having a job interview, and possibly other reasons. I don't have a specific number of allowed absences, but I'll be on the lookout for regular attendance.

Academic integrity:

Submitting work without acknowledging its source is a violation of academic integrity. *I'll report any apparent violation of the academic integrity rules to the Dean. There will be no exceptions.*

Working on projects in groups is allowed and even encouraged.

Course materials:

This course doesn't use Moodle. Instead, I'll post all the course's materials on a shared Google Drive.

You should already have received an invitation to the course's Google Drive folder via email. If you don't have access to the class's Google Drive folder, please let me know.

E-mail and Google Calendar:

Please check your Drew e-mail every day.

Also, the class's Google calendar contains all the important assignment dates, exam dates, and other events for this course. I've set up sharing of the class calendar for each student in this class. Please check the class calendar regularly for events and for updates. Better yet, create notifications for

items that I post on the calendar. (Go to the settings for the class's calendar and look for Event Notifications and General Notifications.)

You should already have received an invitation to the course's Google Calendar via email. If you don't have access to the class's Google calendar, please let me know.

Changes and announcements:

There's often some important piece of class business that I need to discuss in the beginning of the class period. Occasionally, I announce important changes in class (change of an exam time, change of something in this syllabus, etc.) If you miss a class, be sure to ask a friend about the announcements I made during that class.

University-wide policies:

Academic Integrity Policy Statement

All students are required to uphold the highest academic standards. Any case of academic dishonesty will be dealt with according to the guidelines and procedures outlined in Drew University's [Standards of Academic Integrity: Guidelines and Procedures](#), which is located in the academic policies section of Drew's course catalog.

> CSGS faculty, please adapt statement with link to: [CSGS Academic Integrity Policy](#)

Academic Accommodations Statement

Students with approved accommodations through the Office of Accessibility Resources (OAR) should provide the instructor with an accommodation letter by September 6, 2023. If you have not established services through the Office of Accessibility Resources (OAR) but have a temporary health condition or permanent disability that requires accommodations (including, but not limited to; mental health, attention-related, learning, vision, hearing, physical or health conditions), you are encouraged to contact OAR. Although a disclosure may take place at any time during the semester, students are advised to do so as early as possible. For more information, visit [OAR's Website](#), contact Dana Giroux in Brothers College 119B, or at 973-408-3962, dgiroux@drew.edu or disabilityserv@drew.edu.

Absence Policy Statement

Class attendance and participation are integral to the academic experience at Drew University. Along with the course attendance policy, which may outline how attendance will affect a student's grade, students should also be aware of their rights and responsibilities regarding absences for legitimate reasons, as described in the [Absence Policy: Student Rights and Responsibilities](#), which is located in the Academic Policy section of Drew's course catalog under Attendance. Legitimate planned absences may include religious holidays, NCAA-sanctioned competition, academic conference or some Drew-sanctioned events. Students need to inform the faculty member of planned absences in the first week of the semester. For unforeseen extended health issues please see the academic accommodations statement.

Artificial Intelligence Tools Statement

You may use Artificial Intelligence (AI) resources only if an assignment clearly states that is an option or if your instructor explicitly permits it in the syllabus. In such cases, you may only use the specific tools or types of tools identified as acceptable and you must adhere to our standards for attribution, validation, and transparency. This means that you must (1) fully document all material that was not generated by you

using MLA or APA guidelines (2) check information generated by AI and take full responsibility for its accuracy, and (3) be able to identify where and how you used any AI tools and how they contributed to your work. Assessment may focus on how you improve on and surpass the initial contributions of the AI. Use of any AI tools without permission is unacceptable and will be reported as an academic integrity violation. If you have any doubts about what is acceptable please discuss them with the professor.

Affordable Textbook Resources

The [Gabriella D. Ramirez Textbook Lending Library](#), housed in the Drew University Library, is a student-developed resource to assist with textbook access for students who have financial constraints. For information regarding eligibility status, please review the request form located on the Lending Library [webpage](#). For questions, please contact the University Library at library@drew.edu.

DRAFT